Work and careers

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

Article: The changing world of work (185 words)

The modern **workforce** is very different from the one our grandparents knew. Few people now expect a single employer for life; instead they build a **career ladder** across several jobs, often **hunting for** the next **vacancy**. A good **salary** is still important, but surveys show that a healthy **work-life balance** often matters more than a **promotion**, and that **motivation** comes from meaningful tasks as much as from pay.

Technology has made **remote work** and **freelance** contracts common, and an ambitious **entrepreneur** can start a company from a laptop. Not everyone gains. Long **overtime**, an exhausting **commute** and the fear of becoming **redundant** when a firm cuts costs all damage **job security**. Young people struggle to find stable work; an **internship** may be unpaid, and **unemployment** among the young is persistently high. Meanwhile many industries face a shortage of **skilled** staff.

Good **teamwork** and supportive **colleague** relationships can **make up for** difficult conditions, and companies that understand this tend to **hold on to** their best people. When employees **retire** after decades of service, they leave more than a vacant desk: they take experience that is hard to replace.

Useful phrases from the article

PHRASE	MEANING
hunting for	searching hard for
make up for	compensate for
hold on to	keep

The 20 new words

WORD		MEANING	EXAMPLE
workforce	n	all the people who work in a place	*The workforce is getting older.*
unemployment	n	having no job	*Youth unemployment is a major problem.*
career ladder	n	the path of promotion in a job	*She climbed the career ladder quickly.*
work-life balance	n	the balance between job and personal life	*Flexible hours improve work-life balance.*
salary	n	regular pay for a job	*The salary is higher in the capital.*
promotion	n	a move to a better job	*He worked hard for a promotion.*
remote work	n	working away from the office	*Remote work saves commuting time.*

job security	n	the likelihood of keeping your job	*Teachers often have good job security.*
entrepreneur	n	a person who starts a business	*Young entrepreneurs need funding.*
colleague	n	a person you work with	*Her colleagues helped her settle in.*
redundant	adj	losing a job because it is not needed	*Hundreds of workers were made redundant.*
overtime	n	extra hours of work	*Long overtime causes tiredness.*
internship	n	short-term work experience	*An internship gives students useful skills.*
freelance	adj	working for several clients, not one employer	*A freelance designer chooses her own projects.*
retire	v	to stop working because of age	*Many people retire at sixty-five.*
vacancy	n	a job that is available	*The company has three vacancies.*
skilled	adj	having training and ability	*There is a shortage of skilled workers.*
commute	v	to travel regularly to work	*She commutes by train for two hours.*
motivation	n	the reason or energy to do something	*Good pay is not the only motivation.*
teamwork	n	working together as a group	*Teamwork produces better results.*

Revision: 10 words from last week

WORD		MEANING
sedentary	adj	involving a lot of sitting
obesity	n	a serious condition of being very overweight
balanced diet	n	food with the right mix of nutrients
life expectancy	n	how long people usually live
chronic	adj	lasting a long time
preventive	adj	stopping something before it happens
well-being	n	the state of being healthy and happy
stress	n	worry that makes you feel tense
epidemic	n	a disease that spreads quickly in an area
vaccination	n	an injection that protects from disease

Practice: fill the gaps

commute · motivation · retire · skilled · remote work · entrepreneur · overtime · unemployment

1. She _____ by train for two hours.

2. Good pay is not the only _____.
3. Many people _____ at sixty-five.
4. There is a shortage of _____ workers.
5. _____ saves commuting time.
6. Young _____ need funding.
7. Long _____ causes tiredness.
8. Youth _____ is a major problem.

More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

apprentice (n): a person learning a trade
workload (n): the amount of work to be done
employer (n): a person or company that gives jobs
employee (n): a person paid to work
full-time (adj): working normal hours each week
part-time (adj): working fewer hours
flexitime (n): choosing your own working hours
shift work (n): work done at different times of the day
manual (adj): done by hand
white-collar (adj): office-based
blue-collar (adj): doing physical work
CV (n): a document listing your experience
interview (n): a meeting to judge a job candidate
résumé (n): a summary of your career
hire (v): to give someone a job
fire (v): to make someone leave a job
resign (v): to leave a job by choice
sack (v): to dismiss from a job
training (n): teaching skills for a job
workplace (n): the place where people work
gender pay gap (n): difference in pay between men and women
minimum wage (n): the lowest legal pay
pension (n): regular payment after retirement
labor market (n): the supply and demand for workers
job satisfaction (n): feeling happy in your work
burnout (n): exhaustion from too much work
deadline (n): the time by which work must be done
career break (n): a period away from work
networking (n): meeting people to help your career
fulfilling (adj): giving a feeling of satisfaction

Topic kit: what to know about this topic

Writing Task 2 questions you may meet

1. Some people prefer a stable job; others prefer to take risks. Discuss both views and give your opinion.
2. Many employees now work from home. What are the advantages and disadvantages?
3. Young people find it hard to get a job. What are the causes and solutions?
4. A high salary is the most important factor in choosing a job. To what extent do you agree?

Ideas you can use in essays and in speaking

- **For / good:** Remote work saves commuting time and allows a better work-life balance.
- **Against / bad:** Home workers may feel isolated and find it hard to separate work from private life.
- **For / good:** A stable job gives security for loans and family plans.
- **Against / bad:** Risk-takers can gain faster promotion and personal satisfaction.
- **For / good:** Internships give young people experience that employers value.
- **Against / bad:** Entry-level jobs often require experience, which creates a circle that is hard to break.

Speaking

Part 1

- Do you work or study?
- What do you like about your job or studies?
- What job did you want as a child?
- Would you like to work from home?
- What is your ideal job?

Part 3

- Is job satisfaction more important than salary?
- How will jobs change in the next twenty years?
- Should the retirement age be raised?
- What makes a good boss?

Part 2 cue card. Describe a job you would like to do in the future. You should say: what it is, what skills it needs, how you would prepare, and explain why it appeals to you.

Answers

1. commutes (commute)
2. motivation (motivation)
3. retire (retire)
4. skilled (skilled)
5. Remote work (remote work)
6. entrepreneurs (entrepreneur)
7. overtime (overtime)
8. unemployment (unemployment)